

Evaluation Plan

Digital Literacy Fundamentals — Measuring Whether the Course Actually Works

1. Framework

Structured around Kirkpatrick's four levels, adapted for this platform's constraints, consistent with the approach already used elsewhere in this portfolio. This course has a meaningfully better Level 2 measurement story than a writing-craft course, because the capstone produces real, observable task-completion data — not just self-reported reaction.

Level	Question It Answers	Measurable Here?
1. Reaction	Did learners find the course usable and tolerable to get through?	Yes — directly, via a feedback field and platform analytics.
2. Learning	Did learners actually build the target skill (operating a mouse, keyboard, and windows)?	Yes, directly — unlike a writing course where the work product lives on paper by design, the capstone simulation produces real, observable completion data for each task: did the learner successfully open a window, type text, switch windows, without help.
3. Behavior	Does the skill transfer to a real laptop outside the platform?	Not measurable from platform data alone — would require learner self-report after release, or facility follow-up, out of scope for this course in isolation.
4. Results	Does this move a broader outcome (employment rate, reentry success)?	Out of scope for a single course — belongs at a program or curriculum level.

2. What This Plan Actually Measures

Given the Level 3–4 limits above, this plan focuses on Level 1 reaction data plus Level 2 behavioral data from the capstone — the strongest, most direct measurement available anywhere in this portfolio, because the capstone is the first piece of content here where the platform can observe the actual skill being performed, not just infer it from completion of a passive screen.

Behavioral Signals (Platform Analytics, Aggregate Only)

Signal	What It Tests
Completion rate for each of the five teaching lessons (1–5)	Baseline engagement — confirms learners are progressing through the conceptual lessons before reaching the capstone, not dropping off before ever attempting the hands-on portion.
Capstone task completion rate, per task (open a window, type text, switch windows, minimize)	Directly tests whether each individual skill from Lessons 2–5 actually transferred to independent performance — the most granular, most useful data this evaluation plan can produce.

Signal	What It Tests
Capstone task retry rate, in aggregate only	Tests whether any single task is disproportionately difficult, which would flag either a content gap in the teaching lesson behind it or a usability problem in the simulation itself — without exposing any individual learner's retry count.
Time spent per teaching lesson relative to course average	Indirect check on whether any lesson's content is confusing rather than just thorough — unusually long dwell time could indicate the accordion pacing isn't working for that lesson specifically.

Self-Reported Reaction

An open-text “How would you improve this course?” field at the end of the capstone, consistent with the feedback-field pattern already established elsewhere in this portfolio. Reviewed as a set after each cohort, coded for recurring themes, and fed back into the next revision cycle.

3. Evaluation Constraints — This Measurement Has to Follow Its Own Rules

- All behavioral data reviewed in aggregate only. No individual learner's capstone completion time, retry count, or task-level performance should be visible to facility staff at a level that could read as monitoring compliance or effort.
- No data from this evaluation should be usable to penalize a learner — not for a slow completion, not for a high retry count on any capstone task, not for an incomplete run.
- Feedback field responses reviewed anonymized and in aggregate, never attributed to individual learners in any report.

4. Cadence

Checkpoint	What Happens
After first cohort (approx. 50–100 completions)	Pull lesson completion rates and capstone per-task completion/retry rates. Read the first batch of feedback responses.
Quarterly thereafter	Re-check the same metrics for drift. A capstone task that performed well at launch can become a bottleneck if, for example, device hardware in circulation changes.
Any time the course is revised again	Re-baseline. Don't compare post-revision capstone data against a stale pre-revision number from a different build.

5. What Would Trigger a Re-Audit

- Any single capstone task shows a completion rate meaningfully lower than the others — would point to either a gap in the teaching lesson behind it or a usability problem specific to that interaction, and the Task & Content Analysis hierarchy for that skill should be revisited first.
- High retry rates across most or all capstone tasks, rather than one specific task — would suggest the input-model decision itself (tap-based, no simulated cursor) needs reconsideration, not just a content fix.

- Feedback responses cluster around a theme not addressed anywhere in this document set — evidence of a gap the original design process didn't catch, which the Content Quality Rubric should be updated to include.